

Stuffed Bell Peppers with Quinoa and Black Beans (Variation 4)

Tags: vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free, dinner, healthy | Prep: 25 min | Cook: 40 min | Serves: 12

Ingredients

- 12 large bell peppers, any colour, halved and seeds removed
- 3 cup quinoa, rinsed
- 6 cups vegetable stock
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 3 small onion, finely diced
- 9 garlic cloves, minced
- 3 can (400 g) black beans, drained
- 3 can (400 g) corn, drained
- 3 can (400 g) diced tomatoes, drained
- 3 tsp cumin
- 3 tsp chilli powder
- 3/2 tsp smoked paprika
- Salt and black pepper
- 300 g grated cheese (or vegan alternative)
- fresh cilantro and sour cream to serve

Method

1. Preheat oven to 190 °C.
2. Cook quinoa in stock for 15 minutes until tender and liquid absorbed. Fluff with a fork.
3. Heat oil in a skillet. Cook onion for 5 minutes, then add garlic for 1 minute.
4. Combine cooked quinoa, black beans, corn, drained tomatoes, spices, and the onion mixture. Season well.
5. Arrange pepper halves cut-side up in a baking dish. Spoon filling into each half, mounding slightly.
6. Cover dish tightly with foil. Bake for 25 minutes.
7. Remove foil, top each pepper with cheese. Bake uncovered for 10 minutes until cheese is melted and golden.
8. Serve with fresh cilantro and sour cream.

Chef Tips

- Pre-roast empty pepper halves for 10 minutes before filling to soften them and prevent excess moisture.
- The filling can be prepared up to 2 days ahead — fill and bake on the day.
- Use any colour peppers — red and yellow are sweeter; green is more assertive.